Zombie Smash: boss scenes artwork brief

Scripts, scene descriptions and technical specs for whoever makes the new boss scenes. Every boss has the same set of scenes, so this page gives each boss a full script with a description of the picture, the performance and the sound.

Lines marked IN GAME are the words the game shows today. Lines marked PROPOSED are new suggestions you can take or leave. The picture descriptions are suggestions too, built from the bosses' names, weapons and lines in the game, so check them against your character art.

How the scenes work today

Every scene is a full-panel overlay on the game screen. The player can tap CONTINUE to skip ahead. The action freezes while a scene plays.

Scene	When it plays	Length now	What the panel shows today
1. Arrival, warning	The wave is cleared and a boss is coming	0.7 s	"WARNING! HOSTILE APPROACHING"
2. Arrival, Joey reacts	Straight after the warning	2.1 s	Joey Rob's shocked close-up and his line
3. Arrival, boss reveal	Straight after Joey	2.8 s	The boss's first form, name, title and a tease line
4. Mutation	The boss changes form mid-fight	1.8 s (2.8 s for a final form)	New form, "FORM X OF Y" and a line. On the final form of a 3-form boss Joey appears beside it
5. Boss down	The boss is beaten	3.4 s	"BOSS DOWN", the boss and their last words
6. Joey down	Joey loses all his hearts or the base is overrun	3.2 s	The boss's gloat

The story, in the game's own words:

- Dr Mantis wants to become the **King of Proctology**.
- He has brainwashed Joey Rob's old mates and raised a zombie army.
- Every familiar face is now a boss standing in Joey's way.
- Joey's job is to free his mates, stop the harvest and hold the line.

Boss order, with the wave each one appears on:

1. Jordan (wave 2)

2. Glowing Humanity (wave 4)
3. Debo (wave 6)
4. Caffeinated Sloth (wave 8)
5. Disco Man (wave 10)
6. Fat Amy (wave 12)
7. Dr Mantis (wave 14)

Common ingredients

Use these for every boss so the scenes feel like one series.

- **Panel size:** portrait, about 3:4. It is designed at 343 × 450 and should be delivered at 2×, which is 686 × 900. Keep the important faces in the middle 80%, because the console frame and the CONTINUE button cover the edges.
- **Joey Rob in the shock scene:** a close-up with wide eyes, then something specific for each boss (see below).
- **Joey Rob in the victory scene:** a short, tired smile or a nod. Never a gloat. These are his friends.
- **Tone:** dark comedy. The bosses are friends who have been turned. The humour comes from the mates being themselves, even while brainwashed.
- **Mantis's influence:** a faint green "harvest" glow in the eyes of every brainwashed boss. It flares in each boss's mutation scenes and goes out when they are beaten.
- **Music (the new score, all in D minor):**
  - The warning scene has a doom build-up: the heartbeat speeds up and the dread stacks over the wave music.
  - A heavy impact lands when the boss appears, then the fast boss music starts.
  - A victory fanfare plays when the boss is beaten, then the wave music returns.
  - A slow tolling cadence plays when Joey falls.
  - Disco Man keeps his own track.

The three arrival beats, for every boss

1. **Warning (0.7 s).** The screen flashes red and a klaxon sounds. The picture is a stripe of hazard tape with the boss's silhouette growing behind it.
2. **Joey reacts (2.1 s).** The camera jams in on Joey's face. His reaction is specific to each boss and comes before his line.
3. **Boss reveal (2.8 s).** A slow push-in on the boss in their first form. Their name and title stamp on at the bottom. The boss says their tease line and the heavy impact lands on the last beat.

Art direction

- **Look:** gritty, painted, high-contrast and slightly comic-book. Think a tense survival film shot as a graphic novel.
- **Light:** each boss owns one saturated colour (listed in their section), with deep near-black shadows. The backdrop of the scene glows in the boss's colour.
- **Faces first:** the picture must work when seen small on a phone. Eyes, mouth and silhouette carry the scene.
- **Consistency:** Joey Rob looks the same in every scene (same face, same kit, same colours as the existing in-game close-up). The bosses must be recognisably the same character as their in-game sprite in each form.
- **Comic caption:** the words appear in a cream caption box at the bottom of the panel, over the art. Leave the bottom 25% of the panel quiet, with nothing important in it.

How the scenes look today

Today every scene is built from layers, so new artwork can be dropped in layer by layer:

1. A backdrop: a glow in the boss's colour fading to near-black, with faint radiating speed lines.
2. A Joey figure on the left and/or a boss figure on the right (transparent pictures).
3. A cream caption box with the speaker's name and the line.
4. A "CONTINUE" button.

New work can replace any of these layers, or replace the whole panel with one finished picture.

Technical specs and file names

Item	Size	Format	Notes
Figure (boss or Joey), the current method	768 × 768	PNG or WebP with a transparent background	Same size as the existing figures. Leave a small margin so nothing is cropped
Full-panel scene plate (replaces the layers)	686 × 900	PNG or WebP	Bottom 25% kept quiet for the caption box
Comic panel (the style of the intro story)	1024 × 768	PNG or WebP	Optional, for a longer "comic" moment
Short motion loop (optional)	686 × 900	MP4 or animated WebP, 2 to 3 s, loopable	Smoke, glow or sparks only

File names (so the pictures can be wired in without renaming):

- Boss figures per form: `boss-<id>-stage<number>.webp`. These are the existing names, for example `boss-jordan-stage1.webp`.
- Joey reaction to a boss: `joey-react-<id>.webp`

- Warning silhouette: `scene-<id>-warning.webp`
- Boss reveal (if a finished plate): `scene-<id>-reveal.webp`
- Mutation: `scene-<id>-form<number>.webp`
- Boss down: `scene-<id>-down.webp`
- Joey down: `scene-<id>-loss.webp`

The boss ids are: `jordan`, `glowinghumanity`, `debo`, `caffeinatedsloth`, `discoman`, `fatamy`, `drmantis`.

Existing pictures to match: `joey-reaction-close.webp` (Joey's shocked face), the boss sprites `boss-<id>-stage<number>.webp`, and the story pictures `story-mantis.webp`, `story-army.webp` and `story-joey.webp`.

1. Jordan: Fallen Firefighter (wave 2, 2 forms)

Scene colour #ff9a36 (the glow, the backdrop and the name stamp use this colour)

Who he is: a firefighter who held the line against a blaze and lost. Now he is on fire again, and in a worse way.

Arrival

1. **Warning:** red flash and klaxon. Behind the hazard tape, a silhouette with a firefighter's helmet and axe, edged in flame.
2. **Joey reacts**
   - Picture: a close-up of Joey's face lit orange from off-screen. His eyes are wide and his lips are parted. He drops his gun an inch.
   - IN GAME, Joey: "JORDAN?! Mantis got to him too."
   - PROPOSED extra beat, Joey, quietly: "Mate... you're on fire."
3. **Boss reveal**
   - Picture: Jordan walks out of a wall of smoke, his coat smouldering, his eyes flickering green. His axe drags a line of sparks along the floor.
   - IN GAME, Jordan: "Everything burns eventually."
   - Sound: a low, slow roar of fire under the heartbeat, then the heavy impact.

Mutation (form 2 of 2): "The fire is spreading!"

- Picture: his coat catches, flames climb his arms and his whole body ignites. He throws his head back and the green in his eyes flares.
- IN GAME: "The fire is spreading!" and then "Jordan is fully ignited!"
- Sound: a whoomph of ignition and a rising roar.

Boss down

- Picture: the flames die out. Jordan sinks to his knees, soot-black and human again, his helmet on the ground. The green glow leaves his eyes.
- IN GAME, Jordan: "Tell them... I held the line."
- IN GAME, Joey: "You did. Mantis is next."
- Sound: the victory fanfare, with the fire fading under it.

Joey down

- Picture: Joey on one knee, Jordan standing over him with his axe held low and a wry grin.
- IN GAME, Jordan: "You should've brought a hose."

2. Glowing Humanity: Radiant Test Subject (wave 4, 2 forms)

Scene colour #9fff57 (the glow, the backdrop and the name stamp use this colour)

Who he is: a test subject who glows. He is cheerful, which is the unsettling part.

Arrival

1. **Warning:** red flash. A green-yellow glow bleeds in around the hazard tape.
2. **Joey reacts**
   - Picture: Joey squints and shields his eyes with his hand as a green light washes over his face.
   - IN GAME, Joey: "GLOWING HUMANITY?!"
   - PROPOSED extra beat, Joey, to himself: "Of course he's glowing."
3. **Boss reveal**
   - Picture: a figure in a haze of neon, with colour cycling through his skin. Glow sticks hang from him.
   - IN GAME, Glowing Humanity: "I'm gonna make you glow, Joe."
   - Sound: a deep hum under the music that rises in pitch.

Mutation (form 2 of 2): "The radiation is spiking!"

- Picture: the glow sticks burst, colour floods the panel and the figure swells with light.
- IN GAME: "The radiation is spiking!" and then "Full neon mutation. Finish it!"
- Sound: a rising electrical whine that cuts out on a flash.

Boss down

- Picture: the light drains out of him in one rush. He is dim, normal-sized and slumped, with the green gone from his eyes.
- IN GAME, Glowing Humanity: "Ah man... who turned the lights out?"
- IN GAME, Joey: "Mantis does not get another test subject."

Joey down

- Picture: the whole panel white-hot, with Joey a dark shape in the glare.
- IN GAME, Glowing Humanity: "Ah, look — Joe got the glow."

3. Debo: Iron Enforcer (wave 6, 2 forms)

Scene colour #f1c25d (the glow, the backdrop and the name stamp use this colour)

Who he is: a huge, armoured bruiser with a chain and a pile of barrels. He is calm and slow, and the threat is in how calm he is.

Arrival

1. **Warning:** red flash. Heavy footsteps shake the hazard tape.
2. **Joey reacts**
   - Picture: Joey's face, eyes wide and jaw tight. The floor shakes and dust falls past him.
   - IN GAME, Joey: "DEBO?! This just got serious."
   - PROPOSED extra beat: Joey checks his belt.
3. **Boss reveal**
   - Picture: a low angle on Debo, huge, with a chain wrapped around his fist and a barrel under one arm. He cracks his neck.
   - IN GAME, a narrator-style tease: "Joey better tuck that chain in... here come Debo."
   - Sound: slow heavy footsteps in time with the heartbeat, then the impact.

Mutation (form 2 of 2): "Debo is still coming!"

- Picture: one pauldron cracks off, the armour splits and Debo's eyes burn green. He picks up a second barrel.
- IN GAME: "Debo is still coming!" and then "Armour cracked. Keep the pressure on!"
- Sound: metal tearing and a low growl.

Boss down

- Picture: he drops to one knee, the chain slips from his hand, and the barrel rolls away.
- IN GAME, Debo: "Smack my punk ass."
- IN GAME, Joey: "Big man is down. Keep moving."

Joey down

- Picture: Debo stands over him and the chain swings back and forth.
- IN GAME, Debo: "Who else want some Debo?"

4. Caffeinated Sloth: Overcaffeinated Test Subject (wave 8, 2 forms)

Scene colour #cb9b6c (the glow, the backdrop and the name stamp use this colour)

Who he is: a zombie sloth who should be slow, but isn't. The comedy is the contrast between his slow voice and his speed.

Arrival

1. **Warning:** red flash. The klaxon is quickly overtaken by a fast, jittery coffee-bean rattle.
2. **Joey reacts**
   - Picture: Joey's head turns a fraction too slowly while the background blurs past him.
   - IN GAME, Joey: "Is that CAFFEINATED SLOTH?!"
   - PROPOSED extra beat: "Sloths are slow. SLOTHS ARE SLOW."
3. **Boss reveal**
   - Picture: the sloth hangs upside down from a pipe and drains a coffee. His eyes are wide and shaking, with a green pinprick pupil.
   - IN GAME, Caffeinated Sloth: "One coffee... isn't enough."
   - Sound: a slow drawn-out voice over a frantic ticking.

Mutation (form 2 of 2): "The caffeine is kicking in!"

- Picture: coffee cups pile around him, his arms blur and he vibrates into an after-image.
- IN GAME: "The caffeine is kicking in!" and then "Full frenzy. Keep firing!"
- Sound: a rising espresso-machine hiss and a frantic drum fill.

Boss down

- Picture: he slows, finally, to a sloth's speed. He reaches for a cup that is empty and sags.
- IN GAME, Caffeinated Sloth: "Need... one... more... coffee..."
- IN GAME, Joey: "That was not slow at all."

Joey down

- Picture: the sloth, very still and very calm. For once he looks smug.
- IN GAME, Caffeinated Sloth: "Decaf? Never. You're slower than me."

5. Disco Man: The Last Dance (wave 10, 2 forms)

Scene colour #e98aff (the glow, the backdrop and the name stamp use this colour)

Who he is: one of Joey's mates, still dancing, with a mirror ball and a pot of tea. This is the one boss whose theme is a different music track.

Arrival

1. **Warning:** red flash with a sweep of coloured disco light across the tape.
2. **Joey reacts**
   - Picture: Joey's face lit in pink and blue. A smile starts and then he stops himself.
   - IN GAME, Joey: "DISCO MAN?! He's still got the moves!"
   - PROPOSED extra beat: Joey reluctantly taps his foot.
3. **Boss reveal**
   - Picture: a spotlight comes on and a mirror ball spins above. Disco Man strikes a pose with a cup of tea.
   - IN GAME, Disco Man: "come on the lads let's show em how it's done"
   - Sound: the disco track fades in under the warning, with a record scratch on the reveal.

Mutation (form 2 of 2): "The rhythm is changing!"

- Picture: the lights go from pink to red, the mirror ball cracks and the bass drops. Disco Man's moves get faster and more aggressive.
- IN GAME: "The rhythm is changing!" and then "He's turned the bass up!"
- Sound: the track drops into a heavy bass half-time.

Boss down

- Picture: the music cuts out and the lights come up to plain white. He sits on the floor with his tea.
- IN GAME, Disco Man: "joey you little toe rag"
- IN GAME, Joey: "Last orders, Disco."

Joey down

- Picture: a spotlight on the floor where Joey fell, and Disco Man's silhouette leaning over.
- IN GAME, Disco Man: "ah...you alright joey?"

6. Fat Amy: Brainwashed Bruiser (wave 12, 3 forms)

Scene colour #ff83bd (the glow, the backdrop and the name stamp use this colour)

Who she is: a loving friend turned into a tank. Her scenes are the saddest of the set, because she still sounds like herself.

Arrival

1. **Warning:** red flash with a whine of incoming missiles.
2. **Joey reacts**
   - Picture: Joey's mouth falls open and his gun drops.
   - IN GAME, Joey: "OMG... is that FAT AMY?!"
   - PROPOSED extra beat, very small: "Not Amy..."
3. **Boss reveal**
   - Picture: Amy in her first form, with green in her eyes, a missile launcher over one shoulder and a burger in the other hand.
   - IN GAME, Fat Amy: "Come here... my little crumpet."
   - Sound: a heavy tread and a slow, sweet music-box note under the doom build.

Mutations (forms 2 and 3)

- **Form 2:** her armour grows and a donut launcher slides out.
  - IN GAME: "Amy is changing..." and then "She is getting bigger. Keep firing!"
- **Form 3 (final form, Joey appears in the panel):** she is much larger, with plates bolted on and her eyes blazing. Joey is small in the corner, horrified.
  - IN GAME: "Final form. Do not let her through!"
  - Sound: a deep metal groan, then a charging stomp.

Boss down

- Picture: the armour falls away and Amy stands in her normal size, human and tired. She looks at Joey with real eyes.
- IN GAME, Fat Amy: "Don't you love me anymore, Joey?"
- IN GAME, Joey: "I'll love you forever, my biotch ❤️"
- Sound: the victory fanfare, kept gentle.

Joey down

- Picture: Amy looming, with a very wide smile.
- IN GAME, Fat Amy: "Hmmm... I love the taste of that little crumpet."

7. Dr Mantis: Harvest Master (wave 14, 3 forms)

Scene colour #92e158 (the glow, the backdrop and the name stamp use this colour)

Who he is: the villain. He wants to be King of Proctology. His scenes should feel like the climax: grander and darker, but still with the game's sense of humour.

Arrival

1. **Warning:** red flash. A long, low alarm and the hazard tape peels away.
2. **Joey reacts**
   - Picture: Joey's face in a green wash, his jaw set. This is the one boss he isn't scared of. He is angry.
   - IN GAME, Joey: "DR MANTIS... this ends NOW."
3. **Boss reveal**
   - Picture: a throne room of surgical steel. Mantis wears a crown and a king's robes, with a gloved hand raised.
   - IN GAME, Dr Mantis: "It's time for your surgery, Joseph Robertson."
   - Sound: the doom build at its largest, then the heavy impact on his name.

Mutations

- **Form 2:** the crown falls off and a mantis claw tears through the robe.
  - IN GAME: "His crown is down — something is happening!" and then "Half human. Half mantis. Keep shooting!"
- **Form 3 (final form, Joey appears in the panel):** a full mantis, huge, standing among smaller mantis-like minions.
  - IN GAME: "FULL MANTIS FORM!"
  - Sound: a screech and chitin cracking.

Boss down

- Picture: Mantis collapses, the crown rolling across the floor. The green glow goes out of every zombie in the background. Joey stands in the dust.
- IN GAME, Dr Mantis: "The harvest... cannot end here..."
- IN GAME, Joey: "Mantis is down. Infinite survival starts now."
- Sound: the biggest victory fanfare of the game, with a hold on the last chord.

Joey down

- Picture: Mantis standing over Joey, his claw raised to his own face as he adjusts a surgical mask.
- IN GAME, Dr Mantis: "You gotta bow to the Mantis."

Deliverables checklist for each boss

- Warning scene: 1 picture (the silhouette behind hazard tape).
- Joey reacts: 1 close-up of Joey with the boss-specific expression.
- Boss reveal: 1 picture of the boss's first form, ideally 2 to 3 frames for a slow push-in.
- Mutation: 1 picture per new form. The final form of a 3-form boss needs Joey beside it (Fat Amy and Dr Mantis).
- Boss down: 1 picture of the boss defeated.
- Joey down: 1 picture of the boss gloating.
- Optional: a single short motion loop (smoke, glow, sparks) for each scene.